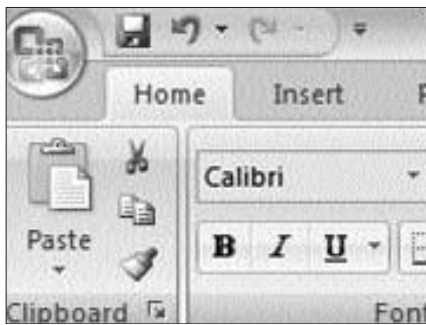


The UI is such an important piece of programming artistry that it even gets a separate name—"Fluent." Microsoft Office Fluent is the common UI presented in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, and Access. Fluent has many components, with the most important one being the Ribbon. The other notable components are named the MS Office Button, the Mini Toolbar, and the Quick Access Toolbar. Feature-wise, Formula AutoComplete, Live Preview, and Gallery are notable inclusions, but these do not appear as controls, rather as usage aids. All these components are discussed in detail in the next section. Fluent also sports a new charting engine which goes a long way in making presentations and charts look... awesome. The interface is definitely a beauty, with the rounded corners, shiny buttons and translucent panels, but those with a more sombre inclination would not like the fact that there's no option to switch to a less flashy interface.



Office Button and quick access Toolbar

1.2.2 Components of Fluent

We now take a closer look at the new UI as implemented in Excel 2007.

The MS Office Button is the replacement for the File menu of the previous versions. This button occupies the left-hand top of the window. It contains the options found previously under the File menu, like Save, Print, program options, etc. It can be activated by the [Alt] + [F] shortcut key combination as before, despite "F" not appearing either in its name or on the button.

The Ribbon is the replacement for all the other menus and toolbars. It is a banner that occupies the top of the window. Its design